

# SŪCHEL

THE CROSSING-SPEECH

## A Grammar, Vocabulary & Sentence Manual

daughter of Old Pelagic · tongue of the fleets

You cannot speak without conjugating the truth.

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### CONTENTS

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|                                    |    |
|------------------------------------|----|
| The language & its family          | 1  |
| Phonology                          | 1  |
| Stress — the mood carries the beat | 2  |
| Nouns & pronouns                   | 2  |
| The verb                           | 2  |
| The four systems                   | 3  |
| Vocabulary                         | 3  |
| Sentences                          | 8  |
| The script & the family            | 12 |

## The language & its family

Süchel is a full language built the way languages are really built: it eroded out of an older tongue, Old Pelagic, by seven regular sound changes, and it grew grammar for what its speakers cannot afford to be vague about. Every finite verb takes a position on the truth of what it says (a veridical mood) and declares which of three clocks it happened in (a temporal anchor). Word order is verb-final (SOV); the noun is simple and the verb carries the world on its back.

Old Pelagic left five other daughters, and each did something different to the ancestral \*k and \*g before front vowels. Ask a stranger to name the seam and their mouth files their birthplace:

| mouth       | the seam (*gel-) |
|-------------|------------------|
| Old Pelagic | gel              |
| Lorkel      | gel              |
| Suchel      | jel              |
| Rudgar      | ghel             |
| Sel         | zel              |
| Beltsel     | dzet             |
| Nubhel      | yel              |

## Phonology

Romanization is one symbol, one sound. The digraphs ch, sh are single consonants; macron vowels ā ē ī ō ū are long — length is quality held, not changed, a held breath. Stress is marked in the IPA with ' before the stressed syllable.

### Consonants — 17

| letter | IPA   | note                                 |
|--------|-------|--------------------------------------|
| p      | p     | labial stop                          |
| b      | b     | labial stop, voiced                  |
| t      | t     | alveolar stop                        |
| d      | d     | alveolar stop, voiced                |
| k      | k     | velar stop                           |
| g      | g     | velar stop, voiced                   |
| ch     | tʃ    | affricate (church)                   |
| j      | dʒ    | affricate, voiced (judge)            |
| v      | v     | labial fricative                     |
| s      | s     | alveolar fricative (voiceless)       |
| z      | z     | alveolar fricative, voiced           |
| sh     | ʃ     | postalveolar fricative               |
| m      | m     | nasal                                |
| n      | n     | nasal                                |
| r      | r ~ ɾ | tap / trill; never the English glide |
| l      | l     | lateral                              |
| h      | h     | word-initial only (hōl, hau, hep)    |

### Vowels — 5 + length

| letter | IPA | as in           |
|--------|-----|-----------------|
| a      | a   | father (short)  |
| e      | e   | bed             |
| i      | i   | machine (short) |
| o      | o   | story (short)   |

|           |                |                       |
|-----------|----------------|-----------------------|
| u         | u              | rude (short)          |
| ā ē ī ō ū | a: e: i: o: u: | the same vowels, held |

Syllable canon: (C)(r/l)V(C); no clusters of three. The old \*w and \*h died in Süchel, leaving long vowels as their tombstones.

## Stress — the mood carries the beat

Four rules, applied in order; the first that applies wins. In a finite verb the veridical suffix seizes the stress — you can hear the truth-claim, because the mood carries the beat. Commands assert nothing, so imperatives are beatless.

### Rule 1

Compounds stress their first member.

NUV-ran · JEL-mar · SÖRN-mai · ZU-kad

### Rule 2

Finite verbs: the mood seizes the stress; anchor clitics are weightless.

ve-RA-ka · ta-NA-mi · hōl-TE-she-zu

### Rule 3

A long vowel seizes the stress in any other word.

SŪ-chel · HŌ-lu · MĀN · ĀN

### Rule 4

Otherwise stress the penult of the stem; case suffixes never shift it. Imperatives add no beat.

i-DRE-nes · VU-re-len · TA-nu, JE-du

## Nouns & pronouns

Number: plural -i (sīl 'crosser' → sīli). Case clitics attach to the noun: accusative -(e)n, genitive -en, dative -ol, locative -eth.

Possession splits two ways. Alienable things take the genitive -en; but kin, one's ship, and one's gaps take the entangled suffix -mai — possession as shared amplitude, not ownership. You say kel-en 'my words' but nav-mai 'my-entangled ship'; to use -en of your own ship is to announce you plan to sell her.

| case       | clitic | example                     |
|------------|--------|-----------------------------|
| accusative | -(e)n  | ishen 'you (obj.)'          |
| genitive   | -en    | somath-en 'of the assembly' |
| dative     | -ol    | ish-ol 'to you'             |
| locative   | -eth   | jel-eth 'at the seam'       |
| entangled  | -mai   | nav-mai 'my own ship'       |

## Pronouns

|   | singular | plural | entangled       |
|---|----------|--------|-----------------|
| 1 | en       | eni    | enmai (crew-we) |
| 2 | ish      | ishi   | ishmai          |
| 3 | an       | ani    | —               |

## The verb

The verb template is STEM – (ASPECT) – MOOD = ANCHOR. Aspect: perfective -t-, imperfective unmarked. Mood is one of five and is obligatory; anchor is one of three and is obligatory on every finite verb. Negation is the particle vo before the verb.

### The five veridical moods

| AL             | suffix | meaning                                    |
|----------------|--------|--------------------------------------------|
| T              | -a     | classically true; settled                  |
| T <sup>-</sup> | -im    | true-as-approached; provisional from below |
| T <sup>+</sup> | -ur    | held-from-above; theoretical, unaccredited |

|           |         |                                |
|-----------|---------|--------------------------------|
| <b>T•</b> | -eshe   | seam-true; self-dual, both-and |
| <b>F</b>  | vo + -a | false (negated plain)          |

## The three temporal anchors

| clitic | from           | anchor                             |
|--------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| =ka    | *kad- 'pulse'  | beacon time — shared, verifiable   |
| =mi    | *mei- 'self'   | proper time — the ship's own clock |
| =zu    | *dzu- 'adrift' | dark time — beyond coverage        |

Motion verbs are ungrammatical without a depth satellite: nuv 'down-tower, deeper' or hau 'surfaceward'. And it is forbidden to place a verb inside the narration of a crossing: the particle ne stands where the verb cannot.

## Worked examples

an sū-t-eshe=zu.  
 an su:'te.fe.zu  
 3SG cross-PFV-T•=DARK  
 “She crossed — seam-true, in time no beacon reached.”

kad ver-a=ka.  
 kad ve'ra.ka  
 beacon speak.true-T=BEAC  
 “The beacon holds true. — the safest sentence in the language.”

jed-u!  
 'dʒe.du  
 go-IMP  
 “Go! — an order asserts nothing, so it takes no mood and no anchor.”

## The four systems

Süchel grammaticalizes what its world makes unignorable: the truth-value of the limit, the anchor of time, the direction of depth, and the place where narration fails. The showpiece is one sentence conjugated three ways — doctrine, heresy, and the tragic truth differ only by their morphology:

THE PATTERN LIMIT-LOC NEG ENDURE-T=BEAC  
 tem kav-eth vo dur-a=ka.  
 pattern limit-LOC NEG endure-T=BEAC  
 “No pattern endures at the limit.”

THE PATTERN LIMIT-LOC ENDURE-T\*=DARK  
 tem kav-eth dur-ur=zu.  
 pattern limit-LOC endure-T\*=DARK  
 “A pattern endures at the limit”

THE PATTERN LIMIT-LOC ENDURE-T•=DARK  
 tem kav-eth dur-eshe=zu.  
 pattern limit-LOC endure-T•=DARK  
 “A pattern endures — seam-true — in dark time.”

## Vocabulary

The core lexicon of the codex, followed by the working vocabulary of daily speech. Every form is derived from an Old Pelagic root by the seven sound changes — nothing is invented at the surface. Forms are given with IPA where the codex records it.

### Core lexicon

|                                                         |                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Süchel [ˈsuːtʃel]<br>the crossing-speech; this language | Sörn [soːrn]<br>the threading engine; the drive |
| Pelgar [ˈpel.gar]<br>Old Pelagic; the Assembly's tongue | jel [dʒel]<br>the seam ʒ                        |
| sū [suː]<br>to cross the seam (v., irregular)           | jelmar [ˈdʒel.mar]<br>seam-pearl                |
| sūath [ˈsuː.ath]<br>a crossing (n.)                     | jelvos [ˈdʒel.vos]<br>seam-scar                 |
| sīl [siːl]<br>crosser; seam-pilot                       | jelsīl [ˈdʒel.siːl]<br>seam-crosser (formal)    |

|                                                                          |                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Idrenes</b> [i'dre.nes]<br>the opened path; the bridge                | <b>Vurel-lor</b> ['vu.rel lor]<br>the Madman's Theorem                   |
| <b>idren</b> ['i.dren]<br>a bridge, an opened way (common n.)            | <b>eshe-ver</b> ['e.ʃe ver]<br>the Tragic Truth (lit. 'seam-true truth') |
| <b>kad</b> [kad]<br>beacon; the pulse; (by extension) time-as-kept       | <b>pevlor</b> ['pev.lor]<br>the logic AL (lit. 'five-rule')              |
| <b>kadur</b> ['ka.dur]<br>beacon-cycle (unit)                            | <b>lor</b> [lor]<br>rule; law                                            |
| <b>zukad</b> ['zu.kad]<br>dark time; unanchored duration                 | <b>somath</b> ['so.math]<br>assembly; gathering                          |
| <b>zu</b> [zu]<br>adrift; (gram.) the dark-time anchor =zu               | <b>Pelgar Somath</b> ['pel.gar 'so.math]<br>the Pelagian Assembly        |
| <b>mi</b> [mi]<br>self; (gram.) the proper-time anchor =mi               | <b>nav</b> [nav]<br>ship                                                 |
| <b>ka</b> [ka]<br>(gram.) the beacon-time anchor =ka                     | <b>navmai</b> ['nav.mai]<br>one's own ship (entangled)                   |
| <b>ne</b> [ne]<br>the gap-particle; the unspeakable interval             | <b>mān</b> [ma:n]<br>hand; crew-hand, crewmate                           |
| <b>nexath</b> ['ne.ksath]<br>a gap (n.); a hole in a life                | <b>chel</b> [tʃel]<br>speech; tongue, language                           |
| <b>nuv</b> [nuv]<br>down-tower; deeper (directional)                     | <b>kel</b> [kel]<br>(Old Pelagic) speech — preserved in liturgy          |
| <b>hau</b> [hau]<br>surfaceward; up-tower (directional)                  | <b>ran</b> [ran]<br>to run                                               |
| <b>hōl</b> [ho:l]<br>to surface                                          | <b>tel</b> [tel]<br>to reach, arrive at; (num.) three                    |
| <b>nuvran</b> ['nuv.ran]<br>running under; dive-desync vertigo           | <b>dur</b> [dur]<br>to endure, survive                                   |
| <b>nuvi</b> ['nu.vi]<br>diver; depth-pilot                               | <b>dol</b> [dol]<br>pit; well                                            |
| <b>nuvdol</b> ['nuv.dol]<br>depth-well                                   | <b>osh</b> [oʃ]<br>mouth                                                 |
| <b>tur</b> [tur]<br>the Tower; the OCT                                   | <b>vos</b> [vos]<br>wound                                                |
| <b>Turmai</b> ['tur.mai]<br>the Tower (reverent: 'our-entangled Tower')  | <b>en</b> [en]<br>I (1SG)                                                |
| <b>kav</b> [kav]<br>tolerance; the curvature limit K                     | <b>ish</b> [iʃ]<br>you (2SG)                                             |
| <b>Kaveth</b> ['ka.veθ]<br>at-the-Limit (the frontier, as a place)       | <b>an</b> [an]<br>she/he/it (3SG)                                        |
| <b>tem</b> [tem]<br>pattern; woven form; (K5) the pattern that may cross | <b>eni</b> ['e.ni]<br>we (plain plural)                                  |
| <b>temor</b> ['te.mor]<br>information reef                               | <b>enmai</b> ['en.mai]<br>we (entangled; crew-we)                        |
| <b>mor</b> [mor]<br>reef; sea-rock                                       | <b>ishmai</b> ['iʃ.mai]<br>you, held-as-kin (entangled 2SG)              |
| <b>mar</b> [mar]<br>pearl; sea-stone                                     | <b>-mai</b> [mai]<br>entangled-possession suffix                         |
| <b>velosh</b> ['ve.loʃ]<br>Formless mouth                                | <b>-ath</b> [aθ]<br>nominalizer (act or result)                          |
| <b>vel</b> [vel]<br>nothing; no-thing                                    | <b>-eth</b> [eθ]<br>locative case                                        |
| <b>ver</b> [ver]<br>truth; to speak-true (v.)                            | <b>-ol</b> [ol]<br>dative case                                           |
| <b>vur</b> [vur]<br>to spin, whirl; to go mad                            | <b>-en</b> [en]<br>genitive (alienable)                                  |
| <b>vurel</b> ['vu.rel]<br>madman; the spun-one                           | <b>vo</b> [vo]<br>not; negation particle                                 |

**ve** [ve]  
to be (copula)

**sa** [sa]  
one

**vor** [vor]  
two

**telnum** [tel]  
three (see tel)

**mek** [mek]  
four

**pev** [pev]  
five

**shen** [ʃen]  
six

**hep** [hep]  
seven

**ok** [ok]  
eight

**nur** [nur]  
nine

**dak** [dak]  
ten

**jed**  
to go, move (always with directional)

**tan**  
to hold, keep

**id**  
to open

**men**  
to wait, remain

**ret**  
again

**ān** [a:n]  
breath

**kru**  
blood

**gal**  
the Still; becalmed vacuum (Dead-Sea)

**lesh**  
alignment; fair phase; luck

**maiel** [ˈmai.el]  
kinsman; bound-one

**om**  
all, every

**vu**  
question particle (final)

**-u** [u]  
imperative (non-assertive: no mood, no anchor)

**ō** [o:]  
vocative particle

**-a** [a]  
mood T: classically true; settled

**-im** [im]  
mood T<sup>-</sup>: true-as-approached (IR)

**-ur** [ur]  
mood T<sup>+</sup>: held-from-above, unaccredited (UV)

**-eshe** [ˈe.ʃe]  
mood T•: seam-true; self-dual

**-t-** [t]  
perfective aspect

**-i** [i]  
plural

**-el** [el]  
agent suffix

**-ur(dur)** [ur]  
duration suffix (kadur)

## Working vocabulary (coined, derived)

### beasts

**hund** [hund]  
dog; hold-beast

**kat** [kat]  
cat; ship-cat

**vurm** [vurm]  
worm; hull-borer

**vejel** [ˈve.dʒel]  
bird; air-swimmer

**kabal** [ˈka.bal]  
horse; ground-runner

### body

**chep** [tʃep]  
head

**luk** [luk]  
eye

**tol** [tol]  
ear

**ned** [ned]  
heart

**bon** [bon]  
bone

**der** [der]  
skin; hull of the body

**pod** [pod]  
foot

**jish** [dʒiʃ]  
voice

**mus** [mus]  
flesh; muscle

**shen** [ʃen]  
to breathe (v.)

**kruren** [ˈkru.ren]  
vein (lit. blood-path)

**food**

ed [ed]  
to eat (v.)

bib [bib]  
to drink

brod [brod]  
bread; keel-loaf

lem [lem]  
milk

**kin**

am [am]  
mother

at [at]  
father

bem [bem]  
child

shir [ʃir]  
sibling; crossing-partner

dam [dam]  
friend; hearth-mate

**mind**

vis [vis]  
to know

log [log]  
to think, reason

vil [vil]  
to want

luv [luv]  
to love

dred [dred]  
fear

**number**

chent [tʃent]  
hundred

halb [halb]  
half

**qualities**

mag [mag]  
big, great

min [min]  
small

lam [lam]  
long

tuk [tuk]  
short

dem [dem]  
heavy

lit [lit]  
light (in weight)

rav [rav]  
fast (v. 'to run hot')

sup [sup]  
soup, broth; wet meal

shem [ʃem]  
seed

kres [kres]  
to grow (v.)

dap [dap]  
meat, flesh-food

gur [gur]  
stranger; one from outside coverage

mār [ma:r]  
captain

velan [ˈve.lan]  
widow; the one left in coverage

nom [nom]  
name

bal [bal]  
elder; keel-laid-first

gōd [go:d]  
joy

trur [trur]  
grief; the ne-shaped feeling

hov [hov]  
to hope; to hold toward T̃

mem [mem]  
memory; what the gap cannot hold

kilver [ˈkil.ver]  
keel-truth; a fact that survives docking

memdol [ˈmem.dol]  
archive (lit. memory-pit)

mol [mol]  
many

pau [pau]  
few

metur [ˈme.tur]  
measure; taken size

hal [hal]  
slow; held-back

bon [bon]  
good; sound (of hulls and hearts) (v. 'to be sound')

mal [mal]  
bad; unsound

pol [pol]  
full

vak [vak]  
empty; hollow

lek [lek]  
near; within hail

telur [ˈte.lur]  
far; at reach's end

**rej** [redʒ]  
straight; true-cut

## sea

**mōr** [mo:r]  
wave

**tid** [tid]  
tide; the breathing of the sea

**grun** [grun]  
seafloor; the true bottom

**skum** [skum]  
foam; spent wave

## ship

**chil** [tʃil]  
keel; the first truth of a ship

**stur** [stur]  
mast; the ship's tower

**stir** [stir]  
to steer (v.)

**shechel** [ʃe.tʃel]  
sail; wind-catcher

**hul** [hul]  
hull

## sky

**ster** [ster]  
star

**lun** [lun]  
moon; any moon

**sol** [sol]  
sun; the home star

**heban** [ʰe.ban]  
sky; the upper sea

## time

**dag** [dag]  
day; one waking

**zun** [zun]  
night

**jer** [dʒer]  
year; one full beacon-round

**nun** [nun]  
now; this pulse

**ant** [ant]  
before; upstream in time

**pos** [pos]  
after; downstream in time

## tools

**schir** [stʃir]  
knife, blade

**ham** [ham]  
hammer; striking stone

**sag** [sag]  
saw; toothed blade

**sheg** [ʃeg]  
rope, line

**kriv** [kriv]  
crooked; off-true

**mig** [mig]  
fish

**velk** [velk]  
kelp; weed of the deep

**salm** [salm]  
current (of water); the sea's road

**salvat** [ˈsal.vat]  
seawater; brine

**porta** [ˈpor.ta]  
hatch, door (v. 'to open a way' > n.)

**gom** [gom]  
cargo; carried weight

**rem** [rem]  
oar; to row

**navdol** [ˈnav.dol]  
shipyard (lit. ship-pit)

**tandol** [ˈtan.dol]  
anchor (lit. hold-pit); the held pause

**nubes** [ˈnu.bes]  
cloud (lit. place-of-under)

**luzkad** [ˈluz.kad]  
lighthouse-pulse; a beacon's visible light

**steren** [ˈste.ren]  
star-road; a plotted course

**zemkad** [ˈzem.kad]  
eclipse; a beacon shadowed

**sob** [sob]  
to sleep (v.)

**drem** [drem]  
dream; unanchored seeing

**ald** [ald]  
old; worn smooth

**niv** [niv]  
new; unworn

**tidkadur** [tidˈka.dur]  
tide-cycle; a working month

**solhau** [solˈhau]  
dawn; sun surfacing

**solnuv** [sol.nuv]  
dusk; sun diving

**net** [net]  
net; woven catcher

**kov** [kov]  
cup, vessel (v. 'to hold liquid')

**pan** [pan]  
pan; flat vessel

**vag** [vag]  
cart; rolling carrier



**mignet** ['mig.net]  
fishing net

### verbs

**vid** [vid]  
to see

**klut** [klut]  
to hear

**dot** [dot]  
to give

**kaver** ['ka.ver]  
to take, seize

**mak** [mak]  
to make, build

**brek** [brek]  
to break

**menda** ['men.da]  
to mend, repair

**porter** ['por.ter]  
to carry

**jek** [dʒek]  
to throw

**binda** ['bin.da]  
to bind, lash

**lukmar** ['luk.mar]  
lens (lit. eye-pearl)

**snid** [snid]  
to cut

**bren** [bren]  
to burn

**nad** [nad]  
to swim

**pal** [pal]  
to fall

**stan** [stan]  
to stand

**shed** [ʃed]  
to sit

**ben** [ben]  
to come

**lib** [lib]  
to live

**nek** [nek]  
to die

**venda** ['ven.da]  
to find (one's way to)

**lus** [lus]  
to lose

### world

**vat** [vat]  
water (fresh); drinking water

**sal** [sal]  
salt; the sea's taste

**tir** [tir]  
earth, ground; settled land

**pir** [pir]  
fire

**luz** [luz]  
light

**zem** [zem]  
shadow, dark

**ven** [ven]  
wind

**rōd** [ro:d]  
storm

**sniv** [sniv]  
rain; falling water

**chir** [tʃir]  
cold

**tev** [tev]  
warm; kept-alive (v. 'to hold warmth')

**pirmor** ['pir.mor]  
volcano (lit. fire-rock)

**venosh** ['ve.noʃ]  
storm-front (lit. wind-mouth)

## Sentences

The phrasebook — forty-one lines composed from the grammar, each with its morpheme gloss and translation — then the three texts. Every Süchel line here is generated through the grammar, not stored as a string.

### HAILS & PARTINGS

<sup>1</sup> **ver ish-ol.**  
ver i'ʃol  
truth 2SG-DAT  
“Truth to you. — Hello.”

<sup>2</sup> **ver ishmai-ol.**  
ver iʃ'mai.ol  
truth 2SG.ENT-DAT  
“Truth to you, kin. — the warm reply.”

- 3 **ō mān!**  
 o: ma:n  
 VOC crew.hand  
 “Hey, mate!”
- 4 **kad ishen tan-u.**  
 kad 'i.fen 'ta.nu  
 beacon 2SG.ACC hold-IMP  
 “Beacon keep you.”
- 5 **zukad-eth, lesh ishen tan-u.**  
 'zu.ka.deth · leʃ 'i.fen 'ta.nu  
 dark.time-LOC alignment 2SG.ACC hold-IMP  
 “In the dark, may fair phase keep you.”
- 6 **hōl-u ret.**  
 'ho:lu ret  
 surface-IMP again  
 “Surface again. — the divers' goodbye.”
- 7 **en jed-a=mi.**  
 en dʒe'da.mi  
 1SG go-T=PROP  
 “I'm off — by my own clock.”
- 8 **men-u, mān.**  
 'me.nu ma:n  
 wait-IMP crew.hand  
 “Hold on, mate.”

## BRIDGE CHATTER

- 9 **nuv jed-u!**  
 nuv 'dʒe.du  
 DOWN go-IMP  
 “Take her down!”
- 10 **hau jed-u!**  
 hau 'dʒe.du  
 UP go-IMP  
 “Bring her up!”
- 11 **jel id-u.**  
 dʒel 'i.du  
 seam open-IMP  
 “Open the seam.”
- 12 **Sörnmai, tan-u.**  
 'so:rn.mai 'ta.nu  
 drive.ENT hold-IMP  
 “Hold, my Sörn.”
- 13 **kad ver-a=ka vu?**  
 kad ve'ra.ka vu  
 beacon speak.true-T=BEAC Q  
 “Does the beacon hold? — Are we in coverage?”
- 14 **ver-a=ka.**  
 ve'ra.ka  
 true-T=BEAC  
 “It holds. — Lock confirmed.”
- 15 **vo ver-a=ka. zukad.**  
 vo ve'ra.ka · 'zu.kad  
 NEG true-T=BEAC · dark.time  
 “No lock. We're dark.”
- 16 **tem tan-u, eni om.**  
 tem 'ta.nu · 'e.ni om  
 pattern hold-IMP · 1PL all  
 “Hold the pattern, all hands.”

## CURSES & OATHS

- 17 **jelvos!**  
 'dʒel.vos  
 seam.scar  
 “Scar! — Damn it.”

18 **velosh ishen oshu!**  
 've.loʃ 'i.jen 'o.fu  
 Formless.mouth 2SG.ACC swallow-IMP  
 “May a Formless mouth swallow you!”

19 **vo-tem!**  
 'vo.tem  
 NEG-pattern  
 “Shapeless! — you incoherent waste.”

20 **kru jel-eth!**  
 kru 'dʒe.leth  
 blood seam-LOC  
 “Blood at the seam!”

21 **an vo hōl-u!**  
 an vo 'ho:.lu  
 3SG NEG surface-IMP  
 “May he never surface!”

22 **gal ishen tan-u!**  
 gal 'i.jen 'ta.nu  
 the.still 2SG.ACC hold-IMP  
 “May the Still hold you!”

23 **vurel-en chel!**  
 'vu.re.len tʃel  
 madman-GEN speech  
 “Madman's talk!”

24 **en ver-a=mi: ...**  
 en ve'ra.mi  
 1SG speak.true-T=PROP  
 “I swear by my own clock: ...”

## PRAYERS & BLESSINGS

25 **Turmai, enen tan-u.**  
 'tur.mai 'e.nen 'ta.nu  
 Tower.ENT 1SG.ACC hold-IMP  
 “O our Tower, hold me.”

26 **kad om-ol ver-u.**  
 kad 'o.mol 've.ru  
 beacon all-DAT speak.true-IMP  
 “Beacon, speak true for all.”

27 **jel lesh-eth id-u.**  
 dʒel 'le.jeth 'i.du  
 seam alignment-LOC open-IMP  
 “Seam, open in fair phase.”

28 **enmai nexath-mai tan-a=mi.**  
 'en.mai 'ne.ksath.mai ta'na.mi  
 1PL.ENT gap-ENT hold-T=PROP  
 “We keep our gaps.”

29 **an zu jed-t-a=mi.**  
 an zu dʒed'ta.mi  
 3SG adrift go-PFV-T=PROP  
 “She has gone adrift. — She is dead.”

30 **hōl-eshe=zu, maiel.**  
 ho:'le.fe.zu 'mai.el  
 surface-T•=DARK kinsman  
 “Surface — seam-true — in the dark, kinsman.”

31 **ver enmai-eth ve-a=ka.**  
 ver en'mai.eth ve'a.ka  
 truth 1PL.ENT-LOC be-T=BEAC  
 “Truth is among us.”

32 **eshe-ver men-a=zu.**  
 'e.fe.ver me'na.zu  
 seam.true-truth wait-T=DARK  
 “The Tragic Truth waits in the dark.”

## THE DRIVE-LITANY

- 33 **Sörnmai, ān tan-u.**  
 'so:rn.mai a:n 'ta.nu  
 drive.ENT breath hold-IMP  
 “My Sörn, hold breath.”
- 34 **ān tan-a=mi.**  
 a:n ta'na.mi  
 breath hold-T=PROP  
 “Breath held — by our clock.”
- 35 **nuv, nuv, jel-ol.**  
 nuv nuv 'dʒe.lol  
 DOWN DOWN seam-DAT  
 “Down, down, to the seam.”
- 36 **nuvran ve-a=mi.**  
 'nuv.ran ve'a.mi  
 running.under be-T=PROP  
 “We are running under.”
- 37 **jel id-eshe=mi.**  
 dʒel i'de.fe.mi  
 seam open-T•=PROP  
 “The seam opens — seam-true.”
- 38 **ne.**  
 ne  
 GAP  
 “— (the interval that has no sentence)”
- 39 **hōl-t-eshe=zu vu?**  
 ho:l'te.fe.zu vu  
 surface-PFV-T•=DARK Q  
 “Surfaced — seam-true, in the dark — yes?”
- 40 **hōl-t-eshe=zu. enmai ve-a=mi.**  
 ho:l'te.fe.zu · 'en.mai ve'a.mi  
 surface-PFV-T•=DARK · 1PL.ENT be-T=PROP  
 “Surfaced. We are — by our own clock.”
- 41 **kad ret ver-a=ka.**  
 kad ret ve'ra.ka  
 beacon again true-T=BEAC  
 “The beacon holds again.”

## A pilot's log, after a crossing

enmai kad tel-eth sū-t-eshe=ka.  
 1PL.ENT beacon three-LOC cross-PFV-T•=BEAC  
 “We crossed at the third beacon.”

ne.  
 GAP  
 “—”

enmai hōl-t-eshe=zu.  
 1PL.ENT surface-PFV-T•=DARK  
 “We surfaced, in dark time.”

Three sentences tell the whole voyage through grammar alone: the crossing seam-true, the departure =ka, the return =zu — and between them the mark for the interval that never became memory. A censor could reconstruct the flight plan from the morphology.

## Catechism, with one heretical answer

— tem kav-eth dur-a=ka, vo?  
 pattern limit-LOC endure-T=BEAC, NEG  
 ““Does a pattern endure at the limit — no?” (the catechist, expecting the doctrinal denial)”

— vo dur-a=ka, somath-en ver-eth.  
 NEG endure-T=BEAC, assembly-GEN truth-LOC  
 ““It does not endure — in the Assembly's truth.” (the correct answer)”

— dur-eshe=zu.  
 endure-T•=DARK  
 ““It endures — seam-true, in the dark.” (the pupil who will not pass; the answer that cannot be graded, only punished)”

The pupil's heresy is two morphemes long: -eshe for -a, =zu for =ka. Doctrine and its undoing differ by a conjugation — the entire K5 controversy, miniaturized into a classroom.

### Ne-liturg, for the unreturned

sīli sū-eshe=mi.  
crosser.PL cross-T•=PROP  
“The crossers cross, by their own clocks.”

ne.  
GAP  
“—”

kad vel ver-a=ka.  
beacon nothing speak.true-T=BEAC  
“The beacon vouches for nothing.”

ne.  
GAP  
“—”

enmai ish-mai tel-im=zu.  
1PL.ENT 2SG-ENT reach-T=DARK  
“We reach toward you — approaching-true, in the dark.”

The mourning form for those lost past coverage; every second line is the gap-mark — grief structured as the thing it grieves. The last verb is T, the mood of a limit neared from below, and the entangled -mai on 'you' declares the dead still possessed as kin.

## The script & the family

Süchel is written in Navcher, the fleet script — a featural alphabet in which letterforms encode phonetics. This manual sets the language in the Latin romanization; the script itself, in its living Current Hand and its sacred carved Logos hand, is rendered in the interactive codex (odylang web) and by the command odylang write.

Old Pelagic survives beyond Süchel in four settled sisters and the Wolori's working register. The same proto-word wears each mouth's sound laws — the family, audible in a single syllable.

\*gel- → old gel · lor gel · suc jel · rud ghel · sel zel · bel dzel · nub yel  
\*kel → old kel · lor kel · suc chel · rud khel · sel sel · bel tsel · nub hel  
\*suw-kel → old suwkel · lor suwkel · suc süchel · rud suwkhel · sel süsel · bel suvttsel · nub sühel  
\*wer-stan → old werstan · lor werstan · suc verstan · rud werstan · sel ěrstan · bel verstan · nub berstan

Colophon. Generated by odylang from the NERV//Pelagian Assembly language codices. The grammar, every lexical and phrasebook form, and the interlinear glosses are produced by the package; the PDF itself is written by a dependency-free engine that embeds a TrueType face so the macrons and IPA render true.